

Round 1 — “The After-Party”

8:00 PM – 10:00 PM

Scene: The after-party in the courtyard. Steel drum music, glowing pool, cocktails. Paloma is supposed to give a toast at 9 PM. She doesn't show. By the end of this round, the body is found and the gates are shut.

- You're at the front desk doing conference wrap-up. Slightly harried. Clipboard in hand.
- Pop into the courtyard once around 8:30 to deliver a folder to Val or look for Paloma. Mention casually: *“Has anyone seen her? She was supposed to sign off on the close-out.”*
- **Carry your sealed envelope on you** — pocket or clipboard. Do NOT mention it in Round 1. It surfaces in Round 2.
- When the body is found, go pale. Look at the envelope in your hand. Don't speak.